

leave it at that. I believe in karma and don't wish ill on anyone, because one day, it might come back to haunt me.

Your strained relationship with Shakib Al Hasan made headlines, especially after your omission from the 2023 ODI World Cup squad. Now, with Shakib retiring, how do you view your relationship with him?

Relationships go through ups and downs. The most important thing is to ensure that you're not harming each other because, ultimately, you're both playing for the country. I have never spoken out in the media or publicly blamed him or anyone else. However, I genuinely believe that what Shakib has done for Bangladesh is truly remarkable. You cannot deny that, regardless of whether you have a good relationship with him or not. He is the biggest superstar in Bangladesh.

Do you feel that Bangladesh cricket would have gained further had your relationship with Shakib not turned sour?

Oh, yes, definitely — without a doubt! I believe if our relationship had lasted longer, it could have been a game-changer for Bangladesh cricket. Both of us have done well for the country, and I'd like to think that we both have a positive mindset and want the best for cricket in Bangladesh.

During last year's selection fiasco, did you ever consider reaching out to Shakib and the BCB to resolve the issues amicably?

Very few people know what really happened. Neither they nor I have spoken to the media about it. I still can't forget what took place. If things were to be fixed, both sides needed to make the effort with a clear and open mindset.

Do you think cricketers like Mashrafe, Shakib and yourself, being seen as superheroes in Bangladesh, deserved better treatment and a proper farewell?

For that to happen, the person running the BCB must adopt a



similar mentality and understand that these players have served their country for a long time and deserve better treatment.

However, if the individual is vindictive in nature, it becomes problematic. This isn't just about me not playing in the 2023 World Cup; it could happen to anyone, even a player who has only played two matches for the national team.

Look at India. Everyone talks about the success of Rohit Sharma, Virat Kohli or Rahul Dravid, but the people running Indian cricket are just as important and share equally in the team's success. If those at the BCCI didn't have a clear vision, the team wouldn't have achieved as much as it has.

Similarly, if the person at the top of the BCB lacks the vision for Bangladesh to win trophies or succeed in ICC events, the team will struggle, no matter how talented the players are or who the coach is.

Recently, Faruque Ahmed took charge, becoming the first BCB

president to have played any competitive cricket. How beneficial will it be to have a former cricketer at the helm?

It's too early to say. Look, there are always ifs and buts. In the previous BCB regime, there were three former captains involved in administration. Did the last Board get everything wrong? No, they did a lot of good things too, and that can't be denied.

I may have had issues with two or three people at the BCB, but that doesn't mean they haven't achieved anything.

This time, the president is also a cricketer, so you have to give him some time before making any judgements.

In a recent interview with this publication, president Ahmed mentioned he'd like to bring you into the BCB if you choose to retire. What's next for you? Do you plan to return to international cricket?

The way I finished wasn't